held up as a feminist icon, but that isn't a label that her creators and conspirators are entirely comfortable with, and perhaps for good reason.

"We were never politically motivated with Tank Girl's direction," Martin agrees, "but the fact that's she's such a prominent and disgraceful female is something that we're very happy with. The reason she was created female is that Jamie loves to draw women; he is obsessed with the female form."

"Tank Girl as a feminist icon doesn't really influence my work," Parson muses. "Though her rebellious attitude does, and I think that's what has led her to become so iconic."

"She is celebrated very much as a fun-loving, take-no-shit icon, which is excellent," adds Johnson-Cadwell, "but she's also fucking bonkers and dangerous, which is less healthy!"

Indeed, it's that transgressive thread running through Tank Girl that makes her such a standout character, almost mocking the masturbatory brashness that is embedded within the counter-culture sphere and poking fun at the post-apocalyptic romanticism that still grips us all in *Mad Max* fervour. Made famous by the distinctive style of Hewlett, *Tank Girl* returned post-movie to reveal that her spark was still alive. And the call to work on her strip is a dream for many.

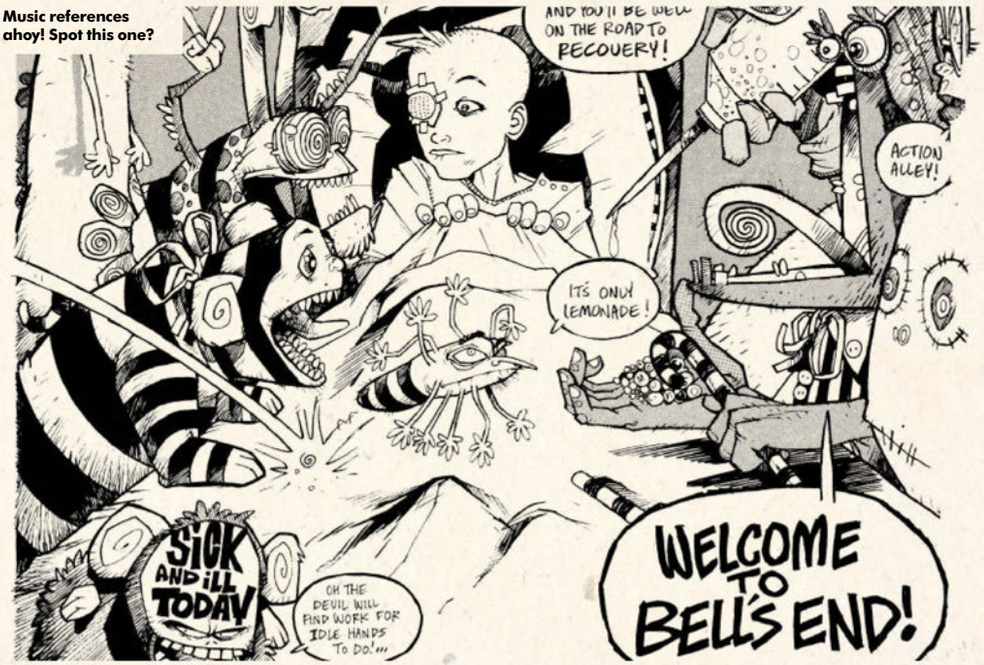
"Alan sent me an email out of the blue one day," reveals Parson. "He had seen some of my work online, including an old drawing of Tank Girl I had done – he asked if I drew comics, and would I be interested in collaborating on something. It was probably the most surreal thing I've ever experienced. To be invited by one of your biggest heroes to work together on one of your all-time-favourite comics... it's the kind of thing you'd daydream about, but it doesn't usually happen."

Riffing on pop-culture staples like *Neighbours*, *Crocodile Dundee* and Keith Chegwin in the early days, usually in rude and raucous gags, the anarchic strip has remained a unique property to work on. "It's very much like an explosion," reveals Johnson-Cadwell. "There's an amount of mulling things over and knocking back and forth ideas. Fairly quiet and gentle, but then there's this monumental shitstorm as things take off and run away with us. Lively, creative and ultimately fun."

"It's a lot of experimenting and having fun," Parson agrees. "Alan's been amazing to collaborate with. He has a very clear idea of where he wants things to go, but is also open to new ideas and artistic freedom.

"I was at first very wary," admits Johnson-Cadwell. "A lot of people love *Tank Girl*, and for many different reasons it seems. The *Tank Girl* Facebook page has a

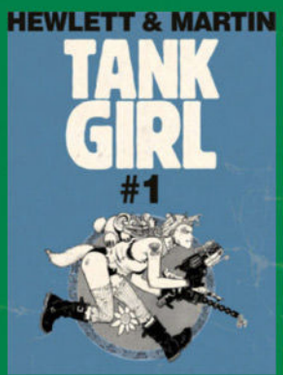
Music references ahoy! Spot this one?





Tank Girl: more hairstyles than David Beckham.

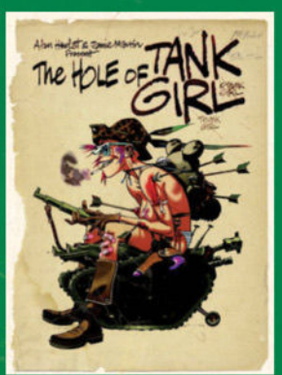
THE TOP 10 TANK GIRL COMICS Where to start with



1. TANK GIRL #1

Jamie Hewlett, Alan Martin

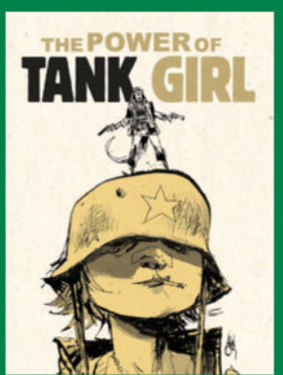
The first in the remastered three-volume series of the original strips, in chronological order and in their original glorious black and white inks – each volume contains a new introduction from Martin and unseen work from Hewlett.



2. THE HOLE OF TANK GIRL

Jamie Hewlett, Alan Martin

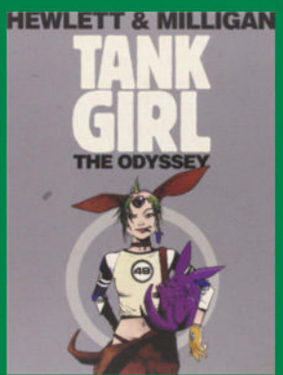
Alternatively, splash out on this deluxe slipcase edition of all the original Hewlett and Martin strips, complete with lots of original art, and unseen work old and new from Hewlett.



3. THE POWER OF TANK GIRL

Alan Martin, Ashley Wood, Rufus Dayglo

A nifty omnibus collection of *Tank Girl: The Gifting* (art by Ashley Wood), and *Tank Girl: The Royal Escape* (art by Rufus Dayglo). That's 288 pages of delicious anarchy!



4. TANK GIRL: THE ODYSSEY

Jamie Hewlett, Peter Milligan

Inspired by Homer, *Ulysses* and junk television, the creator of *X-Men* character Doop and acclaimed British writer Milligan penned this for DC Comics. Now remastered and collected in full.



5. 21ST CENTURY TANK GIRL

Martin, Hewlett, et al

Published last year among great hype, this is a collection of all-new strips from Hewlett, Johnson-Cadwell and a whole host of artists, both series stalwarts and newcomers alike.